



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 4

ARIZONA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Arizona's family courts and child-welfare system.

41

ARIZONA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 59
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 12 MONTHS
MEDIAN TIME IN SYSTEM

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 24, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
10 OF 15

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ARIZONA AT A GLANCE.

Across 41 Arizona families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 59 41 of 41 families reporting with kids	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$10,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 12 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 61.0% 31.7% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 41	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.4	REPORTING FAMILIES 41 of 41	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 10

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Arizona families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

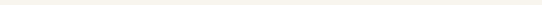
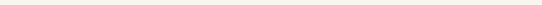
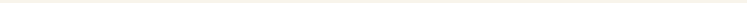
02 THE COST OF ARIZONA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	41	\$10,000	\$54,683	\$2,242,000
Lost Wages	40	\$0	\$41,729	\$1,669,170
Other Court Fees	41	\$0	\$10,561	\$433,000
Therapy / Evaluations	41	\$0	\$4,722	\$193,600
Reunification Services	41	\$0	\$1,511	\$61,959
GAL Fees	41	\$0	\$4,373	\$179,300
Asset Loss ¹	41	\$0	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$10,000	—	—

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$0) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		12	1 yr
Mean months lost		26	2.2 yrs
Total across all families		1,038	86.5 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · ARIZONA

Most families documenting in Arizona are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Unknown		16	39%
Currently involved / "S...		13	32%
Case closed (more tha...		8	20%
Case closed (within th...		2	5%
I am currently in an ac...		1	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and ...		18	44%
Family Court Only		15	37%
Unknown		4	10%
CPS (Child Protective ...		4	10%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		15	37%
5 – 10 years		8	20%
3 – 5 years		6	15%
Over 10 years		5	12%
6 months – 1 year		3	7%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Los...		14	34%
Visitation Only		10	24%
50/50 Joint		9	22%
Children in Foster Care		3	7%
Adopted Out (Rights Te...		2	5%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Unknown		16	39%
Maricopa		7	17%
Pima		3	7%
Mohave		2	5%
Yavapai		2	5%
Maricopa County		2	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Ac...		14	34%
False Accusations CPS...		8	20%
Other: (Short answer)		5	12%
High Conflict Divorce		5	12%
Child Protective Servic...		2	5%

05 PARENT VOICES — ARIZONA

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



My abusive, dx NPD, undx ASPD, never-working ex, his flying monkeys, corrupt CPS (who ignored court interviewer, kids' teacher, and my kids but should have helped us get free from my ex) and corrupt family court have completely and totally destroyed my children, our loving [...]

— ELISABETH

We have been alienated from each other, I was forced to abandon, because of threats and interigation tactics to my children. I cant control what cps is doing to my children, while I am not present in their life, they have to pretend to hate me to appease the father, court, casa [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed it. Evil abuser had everything granted. Children are abused and I'm controlled

— LAUREN

Family Court and CPS have damaged the mental health of my children. There should be accountability for Judges, Attorneys, Psychologist, to are not doing what is in the best interest of the Children.

— MANUEL

As a federal agent, I believe in the law and in justice..."family" court has destroyed that belief; it has destroyed my relationship with my children AND their relationship with anyone else on my side of their family; my children will suffer the adverse affects of having had [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It has destroyed mine and my wife life and we are still crying and wishing that we could be with him and his brothers and sisters that are younger than he is he will be turning 13 in May. I have three other kids ranging from five years old, and 12 years old and my kids love to [...]

— JOHN

Destroyed my family. abused the children. Tortured and extorted me as a father.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Put my children back in the hands of their abuser

— ELIZABETH

My now adult children are now forever traumatized and broken with anxiety and depression from being ripped away from me for a year. After i was their primary caretaker for the first 10 years of their lives.

— MOLLY

It has destroyed the bond with my son and I and placed him in the hands of a felon

— MYKELA

The system has used my family to farm out drug testing, behavior health services and then my daughter was thrown to my abuser even though they knew the circumstances. They were “legal kidnappers” in Havana’s county. The t-shirts they made can still be seen in photos online

— LEIGH

My babies never experienced trauma until they were removed from my home.

— DANIELA

"I survived abuse only to be betrayed by the very system sworn to protect us. Family Court and CPS punish mothers for protecting their children, twisting fear into guilt and love into crime. They can take my children, but they will never take my truth, my voice, or the justice [...]"

— MELISSA

Devastating physical and psychological damage to my son. Years of unimaginable trauma for both us

— MICHELLE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



They permanently altered my life and my young 3 sons' lives. Not only did they steal our time, which we will never get back, but they let our abuser walk away without any consequences or accountability. The trauma inflicted on us will never leave our story,

— LACEY

They victimized the victim, which was me. I was a victim of dv , abuse, narcissistic control and they came after me. My children's only caretaker. Made my husband a saint.

— DESIREE

Destroyed my family, tore us apart and kept going. it will be s miracle if our parent child relationship is ever restored.

— SUMMER

Judge Ashley Halvorson and Kolette Butler Psychologist, JD, PsyD seem to be bias to mom. My ex works for the MCBA I am a patient of Teri Hourihan

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The pain is beyond words for me, her siblings, grandmother, uncle... friends. Everyday I miss my baby. Everyday I love her.

— WHITTNI

Ignored proof of DV. Took my 9 month old whom I had 95 percent of the time and let the abuser have her 30 percent of the time. I paid off all his bills so I could protect her from 50/50. The abuse didn't end.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took away the confidence in the only thing I could say proudly and that was "was a good mom"

— REBECCA

The system has disrupted my children's lives. I have stayed on top of fighting what is right, yet, they refuse to make the appropriate best interest findings. My children were gone for 7 months. Missed 40% of a school year because of negligence. They failed to act!

— ERIC

Traumatized me to this day repetitive allegations living in fear tore us apart stole my daughter

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The system destroyed me financially, left emotional scars,, but worst of all they took the last piece of my childrens childhood and replaced it with complex trama.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Az "family" court has devastated me financially. I have been able to avoid bankruptcy only by taking tens of thousands out of my retirement account, borrowing from family and by doing debt consolidation which has ruined my credit. Since I have had over 5 years of only seeing my [...]

— LAURA

My daughter was taken away directly after birth due to having a flat affect. Crazy! My daughter is 26 now. I missed her whole entire life. A cps worker who was young as can be with no kids was.in my home telling me how to budget my money. Ive never been late on a bill in my [...]

— CANDICE

It has completely ruined my entire life, my dignity, my self-respect, my right to life...to live in the enjoyment of life, peace, liberty, happiness, and have not only basic necessities but the standard of living I had before. It has left me homeless & below poverty. It has [...]

— ERIKA

They separated my infant and gave him to the hands of our abuser. Who continues to psychologically manipulate my toddler against me. Our secure attachment was broken, and I have to watch my child suffer and there's nothing I can do about it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has almost destroyed my current marriage and has alienated my baby girl from her 3 other younger siblings and myself (her mom) She is so young. She was in kindergarten. It's hurt all of us tremendously.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Child Protection services? Instead of protection we got seperation, fear and trama. DCS didn't investigate my family they disrupted it, trust was damaged, and the sense of safety was taken away.

— SHEENA

After 22 years of trying to come from my daughter they now have kidnapped my granddaughter when my daughter was a rape victim

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court was nothing short of another beating.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

I have never been more disrespected and humiliated in my entire life i am 55 years old and have never been away from daughter her entire life up till 18 months ago. This judge has mantly reprimand and told me there are no morals in his courtroom then proceeded to make fun of my [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

33 Arizona parents submitted ranked quotes. 33 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/az.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Arizona report comes from Arizona respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Arizona — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 41 Arizona families reporting here are not the universe of Arizona families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics (email + name + submission date) are applied before aggregation. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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